

GCC Events – Postponement / Cancellation Tracker

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Executive Summary

Since 28 February 2026, a growing number of major events across the GCC have been postponed, cancelled, shifted online, or placed under monitoring due to the evolving geopolitical situation.

The most affected sectors to date include:

- **Entertainment & Sports**
- **Travel & Tourism**
- **Arts & Culture**
- **Energy & Trade Exhibitions**

While several flagship events remain under monitoring, there is a clear pattern of precautionary postponements and cancellations, particularly in the UAE and Qatar.

1. Confirmed Postponements

Sports & Major International Events

Asian Football Confederation (AFC)

- **Events:** AFC Champions League (West Region matches)
 - **Location:** UAE / Saudi Arabia (regional)
 - **Original Dates:** 9–11 March 2026
 - **Status:** Postponed until further notice
 - **Reason Cited:** Safety and security of stakeholders
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World Endurance Championship – Qatar 1812km

- **Location:** Qatar
 - **Original Dates:** 26–28 March 2026
 - **Status:** Postponed
 - **New Date:** To be confirmed (second half of season)
 - **Reason Cited:** Evolving geopolitical situation; safety prioritised
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Longines Global Champions Tour & Doha Equestrian Tour

- **Location:** Qatar
 - **Original Dates:** 4–7 March 2026
 - **Status:** Postponed
 - **Reason Cited:** Airspace restrictions and operational limitations
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Qatar Football Association

- **Location:** Qatar
 - **Status:** All tournaments, competitions and matches postponed until further notice
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Megacampus Summit

- **Location:** UAE
 - **Original Dates:** 6–7 March 2026
 - **Status:** Rescheduled to 18–20 September 2026
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Middle East Energy (Informa)

- **Location:** UAE
 - **Original Dates:** 7–9 March 2026
 - **Status:** Postponed to September 2026
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2. Confirmed Cancellations

Sports

ATP Challenger Tour (Fujairah)

- **Location:** UAE
 - **Dates:** 2–8 March 2026
 - **Status:** Tournament cancelled
 - **Reason:** Ongoing security concerns
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adidas NextGen EuroLeague

- **Location:** UAE
- **Date:** 28 February 2026

- **Status:** Cancelled
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England & Wales Cricket Board (Lions vs Pakistan Shaheens)

- **Location:** UAE
 - **Status:** Match cancelled
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Pirelli Test Races – Bahrain

- **Dates:** 1–2 March 2026
 - **Status:** Cancelled for security reasons
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Travel & Tourism

MSC Cruises

- **Location:** UAE / Qatar
 - **Dates:** 14–28 March sailings
 - **Status:** Three cruises cancelled
 - **Response:** Full refunds offered
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Celestyal Cruises

- **Location:** UAE / Qatar
 - **Date:** 2 March departures
 - **Status:** Cruises cancelled
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3. Shifted Online / Hybrid Adjustments

Social Capital Conference – Heriot-Watt University Dubai

- **Original Dates:** 26–28 April 2026
 - **Status:** Shifted fully online
 - **New Format:** Two-day online program (25–26 March)
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Jameel Arts Centre

- **Status:** Physical events cancelled or postponed
- **Response:** Some programming moved online

4. Limited Programming Resumed (Modified Operations)

Arts & Culture – UAE

Cinema Akil (Alserkal Avenue)

- Limited daytime screenings resumed
 - Introduced “Pay What You Can” seats
 - Focus on community access and flexibility
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Alserkal Avenue

- Select galleries reopened
 - Reduced programming
 - Government safety directives followed
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5. Monitoring (No Final Decision Yet)

Formula One – Bahrain & Saudi Grand Prix

- **Dates:** April 2026
 - **Status:** Monitoring
 - **Statement:** Decision to be made based on safety considerations
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Qatar Grand Prix (MotoGP)

- **Date:** 12 April 2026
 - **Status:** Monitoring
 - **Statement:** Alternative calendar options under consideration
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IAAPA Expo Middle East

- **Dates:** 30 March – 2 April
 - **Status:** Monitoring
 - **Board decision pending**
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M&I Expo (Abu Dhabi)

- **Dates:** 14–16 April

- **Status:** Monitoring
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Doha Fashion Show

- **Dates:** 30 March – 1 April
 - **Status:** Monitoring
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6. Continuing as Planned (Under Close Monitoring)

Art Dubai

- **Dates:** 17–19 April 2026
 - **Status:** Proceeding as planned
 - **Positioning:** Continuing preparations while monitoring situation
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Observations & Emerging Trends

1. **Qatar has seen broader blanket suspensions**, including football competitions and endurance racing.
2. **UAE events are more mixed**, with some cancellations but also modified operations and monitoring.
3. **Large international sporting bodies are prioritising safety language and deferring decisions.**
4. **Cruise and aviation-linked events are highly sensitive to airspace restrictions.**
5. **September appears to be the primary rescheduling window** for postponed conferences and summits.